



Cancer

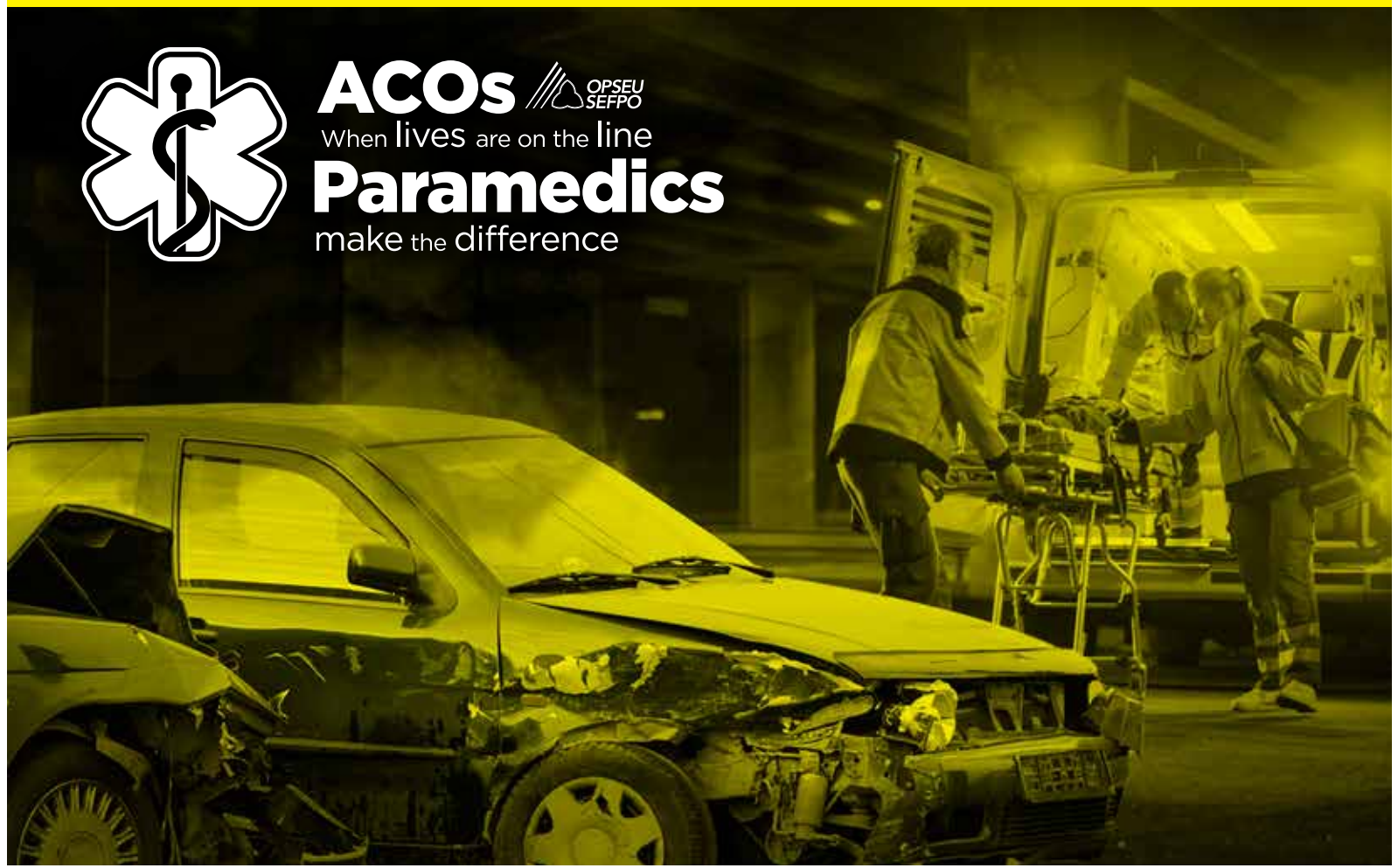
PARAMEDICS AT HIGH RISK

Carcinogenic Exposure

Information Sheet



ACOs OPSEU SEFPO
When lives are on the line
Paramedics
make the difference



Paramedics' Excess Cancers Linked with Workplace Exposures



shorturl.at/1RD7C

"Paramedics share many of the same exposures as firefighters and police as they respond to calls in private homes, public spaces and emergency incidents such as fires, building collapses, motor vehicle incidents and also natural disasters."

- Dr. Jeavana Sritharan

...And Paramedics Are Also Health Care Workers.

Most occupational breast cancers in women associated with night shift work occur among workers in the health care industry. These cancers also occur among workers in the accommodation and food services, trade, and manufacturing sectors.

Shift work at night (generally between the hours of 12 a.m. and 5 a.m.) disrupts circadian rhythms, or the internal biological 'clock' that generates the sleep-wake cycle in humans.

Circadian disruption suppresses melatonin production, disrupts sleep patterns and food digestion, and de-regulates genes involved in cancer pathways.

The International Agency for Research on Cancer classifies night shift work as a probable carcinogen (IARC 2A).



shorturl.at/nqQMO



Shift Work And The Circadian Rhythm

- Canadian Cancer Society

If you have a job or schedule that disrupts your circadian rhythm – for example, it forces you to be awake at night and asleep during the day or if you work shifts that frequently change the times you're asleep and awake – it's hard on your body and may increase your risk of health concerns, including cancer.



shorturl.at/cxSgu

A Recent Study That Is Specific To Paramedics In The Province Of Ontario

This study contributes valuable findings to understanding cancer risks among paramedics and further supports the existing evidence on the increased risk of cancer among emergency medical services workers.



shorturl.at/KW1Fp

Full article: [Cancer Risks among Emergency Medical Services Workers in Ontario, Canada](#)



Our Ask

Enact presumptive legislation establishing that a paramedic diagnosed with cancer doesn't have the burden of proving their condition was caused by their work.

